followed by the re-emergence of the parties. It is unlikely that the army would completely side with the reactionary groups in the country, even though they have links with the right wing Muslim League group in BNP.

The R&AW also believed that Ershad had no special anti-India record.

He seems to have been a fairly happy officer in the National Defence College, Delhi, during the 1975 transition when Sheikh Mujib was assassinated, even though he did not conceal his differences from his Indian colleagues on many questions. He seems to be a professional soldier anxious to develop an efficient professional army. His statements during the last six months have been reasonably coherent and put forward the view that in the special circumstances of Bangladesh's recent history and the problems which the country is facing today, the army has to play a constitutionally legitimate role in

spheres outside the purely professional field.

However, Ershad and his army were cautious of India's influence in Bangladesh. An incident in February 1982 showed that the Bangladeshis were almost paranoid about the presence of Indian officials in Dhaka. Surveillance on Indian diplomatic staff posted at the high commission was intense. On 25 February 1982, Bangladeshi security personnel tailed the car of Indian High Commissioner Muchkund Dubey on the Dhaka streets. External Affairs Minister P.V. Narasimha Rao was forced by the opposition to make a statement. On 4 March 1982, Rao said in Parliament:

It is a matter of regret that the concerned Bangladesh authorities should have arranged surveillance of our High